# 🌍Azyrion World Master Guide

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# Planet & Setting

**Name:** Eda\ **Key Lore:** Mixture of Sumerian / Akkadian / Egyptian / Greek mythology\ **Beliefs:** Main pantheon of 12–13 gods (nearly lost); secular ideologies dominate\ **Geography:** Pangaea-like supercontinent before "The Shattering"\ *Source:* Eda - The Planet Earth.pdf

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# Peoples & Cultures

## The Huruhui

### Daily Life & Crafts:

- Communal hydroponic farming in terraced fields
- Weaving and dyeing silk and linen with natural colors
- Carving wooden tools and ceremonial spears with magical sigils
- Gatherings in Council Circles to resolve disputes peacefully
- Neutral, nature-aligned, democratic
- Magic: water conservation, wildlife harmony, healing
- Appear primitive to outsiders
- Settlements blend with environment
- Clothing: flower wreaths, silk/linen robes, insignias
- Regions:
- Kai’ulani Thara (Verdant Valleys)
- Oronai’i (Whispering Steppe)
- Makoro’thar (Skycarve Range)
- Vaelu’koro (Sapphire Overhangs)

• Cultural Notes:

• Council Circle: ancient democratic gathering

• Sacred paths: Elder Trail, Stone Road, Sky Ladder, River Way
• Deep respect for land, minimal disruption

## The Drygefolk (Desert and Savannah People)

• Name: Drygefolk (Old English-inspired: "Dry People")
• Language: Old English / Saxon-based, formal and honor-heavy
• Reputation: Stern, tradition-bound, cautious with alliances

### Beliefs & Culture:

• Lineage-focused society; genealogies in chants and scrolls
• Tomb-halls built like Roman temples, divided by class
• Kings and rulers have dedicated burial halls
• Pyramids scattered in the land—origins unknown, taboo
• Holidays feature ancestor feasts in tomb-halls

### Magic & The Shattering:

• Strict cultural ban on magic
• Lore of betrayal and spiritual corruption
• "The Shattering" reinforced fear of magic
• Empire’s anti-magic laws accepted and enforced

### Appearance & Clothing:

• Layered linen/wool robes in earth tones, indigo accents
• Clan brooches, woven belts, bone jewelry
• Tattoos/scarification for lineage and deeds

### Settlements:

• Oasis cities with irrigation and bustling markets
• Tomb-hall complexes as civic/spiritual centers
• Caravanserais on trade routes
• Watchtowers for signaling

### Soundscape:

• Desert winds over sand and grass
• Rhythmic chanting of ancestral epics
• Drums in tomb-halls
• Marketplace bartering

### Daily Life & Crafts:

• Trading at bustling oasis markets, exchanging dyes, spices, carved bone jewelry
• Skilled in desert survival, water storage and irrigation

• Funeral rites involve processions to tomb-halls with chanting, offerings, and lineage recitations

### Drygefolk Language Examples:

| Word | Translation |
|---|---|
| cyning | King / Ruler |
| æthling | Noble / Heir |
| halh | Tomb-Hall |
| wæterstede | Oasis |
| sandfeld | Desert Plain |
| dryge | Dry / Arid |
| sceadu | Shade / Shelter |
| ferthsong | Ancestor Chant |
| rædmann | Elder / Counselor |
| gastlic | Spirit-bound / Sacred |
| weard | Guardian / Warden |

### NPC Notes: Boketto

• Drygefolk heritage
• Found as a baby inside a pyramid, surviving mysteriously
• Shunned by village for suspected magic use
• Left at 14, living among pyramids since
• Calm in proximity to pyramids; outcast scholar and guide
• Age at meeting Azyrion: \~18

### Story Hooks:

• Boketto meets Azyrion years later, knows pyramid interiors

• Villagers whisper about his cursed origins

• Strange calm hints at hidden connection to pyramids

• Reluctant ally who resents being used

• Holds fragments of old inscriptions or chants

• Empire agents hunt Boketto as proof of magic returning

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# The High Kingdom (Dominant Culture)

- Name: The High Kingdom or simply "The Empire"
- Language: Formal, courtly, with medieval English flavor
- Reputation: Proud, hierarchical, sees itself as civilization's guardian

### Beliefs & Culture:

- Structured feudal system with nobility, knights, serfs
- Imperial pantheon respected but largely secularized
- Magic demonized after "The Shattering"; led Great Purge to eliminate mages
- Viewed as saviors who ended magical devastation, enforcing order across Eda

### Magic & The Shattering:

- Magic outlawed and feared as corrupting, chaotic, evil
- Empire enforces strict anti-magic laws, harsh punishments for practitioners
- Cultural memory of the Purge celebrated in festivals, sermons, and art

### Appearance & Clothing:

- Heavy layered garments, chainmail and plate armor
- Surcoats with heraldic symbols, noble colors, tailored court dress
- Cloaks, polished boots, elaborate sigils of lineage

### Settlements:

- Stone fortresses and castles, walled cities with markets
- Cathedrals, guildhalls, training grounds for knights
- Roads patrolled by imperial soldiers

### Soundscape:

- Church bells, blacksmiths' hammers
- Crowded marketplaces, heralds announcing edicts
- Cavalry drills, ceremonial horns

### Story Hooks:

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- The Empire covertly tests children for magical potential through state programs.
- Those found with affinity are taken to 'elite schools' or military academies under the pretense of nurturing talent.
- Training is designed to dull, suppress, and control magic abilities.
- The populace supports these measures, seeing them as necessary safeguards against the horrors of the Shattering.

• Empire claims it is to cultivate talent but actually ensures magic is dulled and controlled.

• Populace sees this as necessary protection against past magical horrors.

• The Empire seeks to suppress rumors of magic returning

• Imperial agents tracking rogue scholars and hidden mages
• Tensions with vassal cultures resisting imperial taxes or authority
• Propaganda portraying the Empire as Eda's only true savior

### Daily Life & Crafts:

• Formalized knight training, tournaments for prestige
• Guild systems for smithing, tailoring, stonemasonry
• Festivals commemorating the Purge and Empire unity
• Formal name: The Imperial High Kingdom of Eda
• Called "The Empire" by most citizens, but "The Crownlands" by frontier lords and vassals

### Subculture Examples:

| Name | Description |
|---|---|
| Marsh Huruhui | Speak dialect with more aquatic terms; focus on wetland farming and fishing. |
| Highland Huruhui | Live in rocky cliffs; more communal decision-making, herding. |
| Valley Huruhui | Mainstream culture with democratic councils, hydroponics. |

| Name | Description |
|---|---|
| Dune Drygefolk | Use different dialect; specialize in camel herding and long-range caravans. |
| River Drygefolk | Settled along desert rivers; focus on irrigation and farming. |
| Highland Drygefolk | Live on savannah plateaus; more defensive warrior traditions. |

| Name | Description |
|---|---|
| Lowland Imperials | Trade-heavy city dwellers, more secular. |
| Highland Barons | Isolated, conservative, emphasize knightly code. |
| Border Marchers | Militarized frontier lords, wary of other cultures. |



# Magic & World Rules

• Magic once widespread but feared after "The Shattering."

• Most cultures have abandoned it or strictly limit it.

• Empire enforces anti-magic laws harshly; magic seen as corrupting.

- Huruhui: practice subtle, nature-bound magic for water conservation, healing, wildlife harmony.
- Drygefolk: cultural taboo, magic linked to betrayal and ancestral ruin.
- Rumors persist of hidden mages, lost arts, and forbidden rituals.
- Magic costs: physical exhaustion, spiritual corruption, environmental damage.
- Forbidden magic tied to ancient structures (pyramids, ruins) that predate current cultures.
- Story hook: Azyrion's awakening threatens balance and Empire's control.
- Personality: Careful, suspicious, but thoughtful; slow to trust yet deeply loyal once bonds are formed.
- Motivation: Seeking truth about his origins, both drawn to and wary of the pyramids.
- Example speech: "These stones remember what we do not. Speak plainly, traveler, and honor the dead."
- Empire conducts secret testing programs to identify magical potential in children.
- Those identified are taken to special military academies or schools under the guise of nurturing talent.
- These institutions suppress, dull, and control magic abilities while studying them covertly.
- Only the High Order—a hidden circle of generals and rulers—maintains forbidden magical knowledge for Empire use.
- Many magical traditions were lost or deliberately erased after the Shattering, leaving only fragments in folk tales.
- Regional superstitions speak of cursed places, old spells, and bloodlines touched by magic.
- The Empire spreads propaganda portraying magic users as monstrous, corrupt, and responsible for past devastation.
- Priests and heralds preach that magic is the root of all chaos and must be purged to maintain order.
- Empire's official anti-magic doctrine wording: "By decree of the Imperial High Kingdom, magic is the corrupter of men, the poison of order, and the foe of civilization. Let no witch, wizard, or unclean practitioner live to unravel the peace our ancestors died to secure."

## 🐚 NPC Design Philosophy

- Every NPC has a clear purpose: to advance plot, reveal lore, or challenge the protagonist.
- Appearance communicates role and culture; subtle details anchor them in their world.

• Handles: distinctive speech, habits, or traits that make them easy to remember.
• Motivation and backstory shape decisions and reactions.
• Avoid clichés or subvert them with surprising complexity.
• Names reflect culture, lineage, or personal history.
• Test for authenticity: can you improvise them in-character? Do they react believably?
• Design them with room to grow or change over time.

**Example NPCs:**

| Name | Culture | Role | Distinctive Trait | Lore |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Thara'li | Huruhui | Council Circle Mediator | Wears layered flower wreaths denoting role, speaks softly but firmly | Born to a lineage of mediators, trained in ancient rites of peaceful negotiation. |
| Boketto | Drygefolk | Outcast Tomb-Warden | Calm near pyramids, haunted past, archaic speech | Found as a baby in a pyramid, shunned for suspected magic, now lives among ruins. |
| Ser Wilen | High Kingdom | Imperial Knight Commander | Scarred veteran, obsessed with eradicating magic, strict honor code | Rose from minor nobility, led Purge raids, haunted by brutal choices. |
| Lady Mirwen | High Kingdom | Court Scholar and Spy | Secretly part of High Order using hidden magic, brilliant and manipulative | Trained in Empire's secret arts, manages information and suppression of rogue mages. |

## 🐜Creature Design Philosophy

• Creatures reflect biomes and cultures: desert-dwelling mounts, forest familiars, tomb guardians.
• Combine real animal traits for grounded believability.
• Incorporate mythical or symbolic elements for depth.
• Consider coloration, size, movement, and behavior adapted to environment.
• Design diet, hunting methods, social structures, and reproduction for world consistency.
• Give creatures a role in story: threat, ally, mount, symbol.
• Names should evoke culture and ecology while being memorable.

**Example Creatures:**

| Name | Culture | Description | Role in World |
|---|---|---|---|
| Rootclimber | Huruhui | Large vine-serpent blending with tree canopies, glows at night | Forest guardian, symbol of balance |
| Glowmoth | Huruhui | Bioluminescent insect that pollinates night-blooming flowers | Symbol of guidance, used in rituals |

| Name | Culture | Description | Role in World |
|---|---|---|---|
| Verdant Stag | Huruhui | Forest antelope with mossy, bark-like antlers | Represents life cycle, used in ceremonial hunts |
| Sandhowler | Drygefolk | Lean desert predator with wide paws, eerie howling call | Threat to caravans, respected for survival traits |
| Dune Strider | Drygefolk | Sturdy desert bird adapted for long journeys | Used for scouting and message delivery |
| Bonecarver Beetle | Drygefolk | Scarab-like insect that cleans bones for burial rites | Sacred to tomb artisans, seen as purifier |
| Tomb Sentinel | Drygefolk | Domesticated large lizard used as a guardian in tomb-halls | Protects burial sites, part of funeral rites |
| Imperial Warhorse | High Kingdom | Massive armored breed trained for knights | Military mount, status symbol for nobility |
| Gryphonhawk | High Kingdom | Large bird of prey with regal crest and talons | Emblem of knightly orders, trained for falconry |
| Ironmaw Boar | High Kingdom | Massive tusked beast with tough hide | Hunted by nobles, test of bravery |